

INEQUALITIES

ASSIGNMENT

1. If $c_1, \dots, c_n$ be positive real numbers, show that $(c_1 + \dots + c_n)^3 \leq n^2 (c_1^3 + \dots + c_n^3)$ When does the inequality reduce to equality ?

Sol If $a_1, \dots, a_n, b_1, \dots, b_n$, be real numbers, then by Cauchy Schwarz inequality,

$$(a_1 b_1 + \dots + a_n b_n)^2 \leq (a_1^2 + \dots + a_n^2)(b_1^2 + \dots + b_n^2) \quad \dots (1)$$

Putting $a_i = c_i^{3/2}, b_i = c_i^{1/2}, (i = 1, 2, \dots, n)$ in the above inequality, we have

$$(c_1^2 + \dots + c_n^2)^2 \leq (c_1^3 + \dots + c_n^3)(c_1 + \dots + c_n) \quad \dots (2)$$

Again, putting $a_i = c_i, b_i = 1, (i = 1, 2, \dots, n)$ in (1), we have

$$(c_1 + \dots + c_n)^2 \leq n(c_1^2 + \dots + c_n^2) \quad \dots (3)$$

Squaring both sides of (3) and using (2), we immediately have

$$(c_1 + \dots + c_n)^3 \leq n^2 (c_1^3 + \dots + c_n^3)$$

The above inequality reduces to an equality iff each of the inequalities (2) and (3) reduces to an equality, i.e. iff

$$c_1^{3/2} : \dots : c_n^{3/2} :: c_1^{1/2} : \dots : c_n^{1/2},$$

And $c_1 : \dots : c_n = 1 : \dots : 1$

i.e., iff $c_1 = c_2 = \dots = c_n$

2. If a, b and c are the sides of a triangle and $a + b + c = 2$, then prove that $a^2 + b^2 + c^2 + 2abc < 2$

Sol We know $a + b + c = 2$ and squaring, we get

$$4 = (a + b + c)^2 = a^2 + b^2 + c^2 + 2(ab + bc + ca)$$

$$\Rightarrow a^2 + b^2 + c^2 = 2(ab + bc + ca)$$

Adding $2abc$ to both sides, we get

$$a^2 + b^2 + c^2 + 2abc = 2(2 - ab - bc - ca + abc)$$

To prove $a^2 + b^2 + c^2 + 2abc < 2$, it is enough to prove that

$$2(2 - ab - bc - ca + abc) < 2$$

$$\text{Or } 2 + abc - ab - bc - ca < 1$$

$$\text{Or } ab + bc + ca - abc - 1 > 0$$

$$\therefore a + b + c = 2s = 2$$

$$\Rightarrow s = 1$$

$$(1-a)(1-b)(1-c) = 1 - (a+b+c) + (ab+bc+ca) - abc$$

$$0 \leq (s-a)(s-b)(s-c) = 1 - 2 + (ab+bc+ca) - abc$$

$$\Rightarrow ab + bc + ca - abc - 1 > 0$$

3. For $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $n > 1$, show that $\frac{1}{n} + \frac{1}{n+1} + \frac{1}{n+2} + \dots + \frac{1}{n^2} > 1$

Sol We have

$$\underbrace{\frac{1}{n} + \frac{1}{n+1} + \frac{1}{n+2} + \dots + \frac{1}{n^2}}_{(n^2-n) \text{ terms}} > \frac{\frac{1}{n} + \left(\frac{1}{n^2} + \frac{1}{n^2} + \dots + \frac{1}{n^2} \right)}{(n^2-n) \text{ terms}}$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{1}{n} + \frac{1}{n+1} + \frac{1}{n+2} + \dots + \frac{1}{n^2} > \frac{1}{n} + \frac{(n^2-n)}{n^2} = \frac{1}{n} + 1 - \frac{1}{n} = 1$$

4. Show that $\left(1 + \sqrt{\frac{1}{2}} + \dots + \sqrt{\frac{1}{n}} \right) / \sqrt{n} \leq (2n-1)^{1/4}$

Sol Applying Tcheby Cheff's inequality to the sets of numbers $1, \frac{1}{2}, \dots, \frac{1}{n}; 1, \frac{1}{2}, \dots, \frac{1}{n}$, we obtain

$$\left(1 + \frac{1}{2} + \dots + \frac{1}{n} \right)^2 \leq n \left(\frac{1}{1^2} + \frac{1}{2^2} + \dots + \frac{1}{n^2} \right)$$

$$\leq n \left[1 + \frac{1}{1 \cdot 2} + \dots + \frac{1}{(n-1)n} \right]$$

$$= n \left[1 + \left(1 - \frac{1}{2} \right) + \dots + \left(\frac{1}{n-1} - \frac{1}{n} \right) \right] = n \left(1 + 1 - \frac{1}{n} \right)$$

Taking positive square roots of both sides, we have

$$\left(1 + \frac{1}{2} + \dots + \frac{1}{n} \right) \leq \sqrt{(2n-1)} \quad \dots(i)$$

Again, applying Tcheby Chef's Inequality to the sets of numbers

$1, \sqrt{\frac{1}{2}}, \dots, \sqrt{\frac{1}{n}}; 1, \sqrt{\frac{1}{2}}, \dots, \sqrt{\frac{1}{n}}$, we have

$$\left(1 + \sqrt{\frac{1}{2}} + \dots + \sqrt{\frac{1}{n}}\right)^2 \leq n \left(1 + \frac{1}{2} + \dots + \frac{1}{n}\right) \quad \dots(ii)$$

From (i) and (ii), we have

$$\left\{1 + \sqrt{\frac{1}{2}} + \sqrt{\left(\frac{1}{n}\right)}\right\}^2 \leq n \sqrt{(2n-1)}$$

$$\text{Therefore } \frac{\left(1 + \sqrt{\frac{1}{2}} + \dots + \sqrt{\frac{1}{n}}\right)}{\sqrt{n}} \leq (2n-1)^{1/4}$$

5. If a, b, c are all positive and no two of them are equal, then prove that

$$(a) \ a^3 + b^3 + c^3 > \frac{(a+b+c)^3}{9} > 3abc \quad (b) \ a^4 + b^4 + c^4 > abc(a+b+c)$$

Sol (a) without any loss of generality we may assume that $a < b < c$. By applying the generalised Tcheby Chef's inequality to three sets numbers each of which is the same a, b, c we obtain

$$\frac{a^3 + b^3 + c^3}{3} > \frac{a+b+c}{3} \cdot \frac{a+b+c}{3} \cdot \frac{a+b+c}{3}$$

$$\text{i.e. } a^3 + b^3 + c^3 > \frac{(a+b+c)^3}{9} \quad \dots\dots(i)$$

Again, Since the arithmetic mean exceeds the geometric mean

$$\left(\frac{a+b+c}{3}\right)^3 > abc \quad \dots(ii)$$

$$\text{i.e., } \frac{(a+b+c)^3}{9} > 3abc \quad \dots(a)$$

(b) As in (a), without any loss of generality we may assume that $a < b < c$. Since $a < b < c$, therefore, $a^3 < b^3 < c^3$. Applying Tcheby Che's inequity to the sets of number a, b, c, a^2, b^3, c^3 , we obtain

$$\frac{a^4 + b^4 + c^4}{3} > \frac{a^3 + b^3 + c^3}{3} \cdot \frac{a+b+c}{3} \quad \dots(iii)$$

$$\text{Also, from (a) } \frac{a^3 + b^3 + c^3}{3} > abc \quad \dots(iv)$$

From (iii) and (iv), we have

$$a^4 + b^4 + c^4 > abc(a + b + c)$$

6. If a, b, c are positive and unequal, show that

$$(a^7 + b^7 + c^7)(a^2 + b^2 + c^2) > (a^5 + b^5 + c^5)(a^4 + b^4 + c^4)$$

Sol
$$(a^7 + b^7 + c^7)(a^2 + b^2 + c^2) - (a^5 + b^5 + c^5)(a^4 + b^4 + c^4)$$

$$= \sum (a^7 b^2 + a^3 b^7 - a^5 b^4 - a^4 b^5)$$

$$= \sum a^2 b^2 (a^5 + b^5 - a^3 b^2 - a^2 b^3)$$

$$= \sum a^2 b^2 (a^3 - b^3)(a^2 - b^2)$$

The differences $a^2 - b^2$, $a^3 - b^3$ are both of the same sign, and therefore $(a^2 - b^2)(a^3 - b^3)$ is positive.

Similarly, the other two terms in the above sum are also positive. Therefore

$$(a^7 + b^7 + c^7)(a^2 + b^2 + c^2) - (a^5 + b^5 + c^5)(a^4 + b^4 + c^4) > 0$$

7. If a, b, c are positive and if p, q, r are rational numbers such that $p - q - r (\neq 0)$ and $r (\neq 0)$ have the same sign, then show that

$$(a^p + b^p + c^p)(a^q + b^q + c^q) \geq (a^{p-r} + b^{p-r} + c^{p-r})(a^{q+r} + b^{q+r} + c^{q+r})$$

Show that if either (i) $a = b = c$, or (ii) $p = q + r$, or (iii) $r = 0$, then equality holds

Sol
$$(a^p + b^p + c^p)(a^q + b^q + c^q) - (a^{p-r} + b^{p-r} + c^{p-r})(a^{q+r} + b^{q+r} + c^{q+r})$$

$$= \sum (b^q a^p + a^q b^p - a^{p-r} b^{q+r} - a^{q+r} c^{p+r})$$

$$= \sum a^q b^q (a^{p-q} + b^{p-q} - a^{p-q-r} b^r - a^r b^{p-q-r})$$

$$= \sum a^q b^q (a^{p-q-r} - b^{p-q-r})(a^r - b^r)$$

Since $p - q - r$ and r have the same sign, the differences $a^{p-q-r} - b^{p-q-r}$ and $a^r - b^r$ have the same sign or are both zero. Therefore,

$$a^q b^q (a^{p-q-r} - b^{p-q-r})(a^r - b^r) \geq 0,$$

And similarly each of the other two terms in the above sum is also non-negative, so that the sum is non-negative. This proves the inequality $a^q b^q (a^{p-q-r} - b^{p-q-r})(a^r - b^r) \geq 0$. And similarly each of the other two terms in the above sum is also non-negative, so that the sum is non-negative. This proves the inequality

Also, if any of the conditions is satisfied, then at least one of the factors in each term is $\sum a^q b^q (d^{p-q-r} - b^{p-q-r})(a^r - b^r)$ vanishes and therefore the sum is zero. This proves that the equality holds

8. Let a, b, c be real numbers with $0 < a, b, c < 1$ and $a + b + c = 2$. Prove that $\frac{a}{1-a} \cdot \frac{b}{1-b} \cdot \frac{c}{1-c} \geq 8$

Sol : Here we use A.M. – G.M.

$$a = \frac{(a+b+c) + (a+b+c)}{2} \geq \sqrt{(a+b+c)(a-b+c)}$$

$$b = \frac{(b+a-c) + (b-a+c)c}{2} \geq \sqrt{(b+a-c)(b-a+c)}$$

$$c = \frac{(c+a-b) + (c-a+b)}{2} \geq \sqrt{(c+a-b)(c-a+b)}$$

$$\therefore a.b.c = \frac{[(a+b+c) + (a-b+c)][(b+a-c) + (b-a+c)][(c+a-b) + (c-a+b)]}{8}$$

$$\geq \sqrt{(a+b-c)(a-b+c)(b+a-c)(b-a+c)(c+a-b)(c-a+b)}$$

$$= (2-2c)(2-2a)(2-2b)$$

$$= 8(1-c)(1-a)(1-b) \quad [\because a+b+c=2]$$

$$\therefore \frac{a}{1-a} \cdot \frac{b}{1-b} \cdot \frac{c}{1-c} \geq 8$$

9. If a, b, c are sides of triangle, show that $\left(1 + \frac{b-c}{a}\right)^a \left(1 - \frac{c-a}{b}\right)^b \cdot \left(1 + \frac{a-b}{c}\right)^c < 1$

Sol Since a, b, c are the sides of triangle

$$a+b-c > 0, b+c-a > 0, c+a-b > 0 \quad \dots(1)$$

$$\text{Thus, } 1 + \frac{b-c}{a}, 1 + \frac{c-a}{b} - 1 + \frac{a-b}{c} \text{ are all positive} \quad \dots(2)$$

$$\text{Take } 1 + \frac{b-c}{a} \dots \text{'a' times}$$

$$1 + \frac{c-a}{b} \dots \text{'b' times}$$

$$1 + \frac{a-b}{c} \dots \text{'c' times}$$

And apply A.M. – G.M. inequality

$$\frac{a\left(1+\frac{b-c}{a}\right)+b\left(1+\frac{c-a}{b}\right)+c\left(1+\frac{a-b}{c}\right)}{a+b+c}$$

$$> \left[\left\{1+\frac{b-c}{a}\right\}^a \times \left(1+\frac{c-a}{b}\right)^b \times \left(1+\frac{a-b}{c}\right)^c \right]^{\frac{1}{c+b+a}}$$

L.H.S of the inequality = 1

i.e. $1 > \text{R.H.S}$

10. Prove that $\frac{1}{\log_2 \pi} + \frac{1}{\log_5 \pi} > 2$

Sol Let $\log_2 \pi = a$ and $\log_5 \pi = b$

$$\therefore 2^a = \pi \text{ and } 5^b = \pi$$

$$\therefore 2 = \pi^{1/a} \text{ and } 5 = \pi^{1/b}$$

$$\therefore 2 \times 5 = \pi^{\frac{1}{a} + \frac{1}{b}}$$

$$\text{i.e., } 10 = \pi^{\frac{1}{a} + \frac{1}{b}}$$

$$\text{But } 1 > \pi^2 \text{ (since } \pi = \frac{22}{7} \text{)}$$

$$\therefore \pi^2 < \pi^{\frac{1}{a} + \frac{1}{b}}$$

$$\therefore 2 < \frac{1}{a} + \frac{1}{b}$$

$$\text{or } \frac{1}{a} + \frac{1}{b} > 2$$

$$\text{Hence } \frac{1}{\log_2 \pi} + \frac{1}{\log_5 \pi} > 2$$